Marcus Andriano | October 28, 2026

Roblox Discovery — Feature Proposal

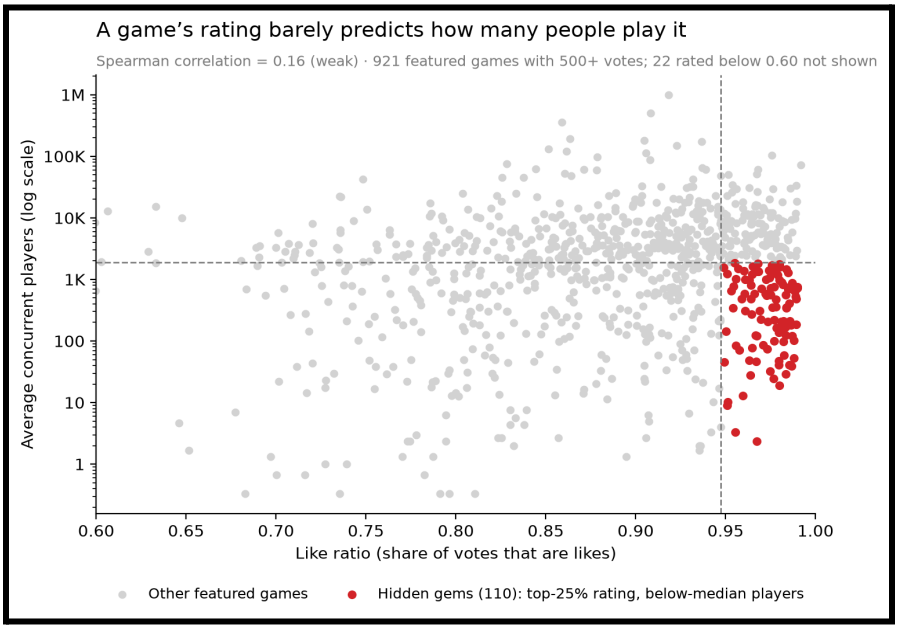
Problem

User: a player who plays the same few games every day and only browses the first rows of Home. *"I'm getting bored with these games, and I'm struggling to find new ones I like."*

Players can't reliably find great games that haven't gone big. Discovery mostly follows popularity, so many of the highest-rated games stay small, and players rarely see them. The same gap hurts creators with well-made games that never reach their first players, weakening Roblox's supply of new hits.

Evidence

Quality doesn't reliably lead to players. I pulled 942 experiences from Roblox's Charts in three snapshots (Oct 18–19, 2026). Across the 921 with 500+ votes, rating barely predicts player count (Spearman 0.16). 110 games rated in the top 25% sit below median players, and only 22% of them are under 6 months old, so most have stayed small for a long time. Meanwhile, the top 10 games hold 38% of all players (Gini 0.81).



On a fresh account, the best-rated small games I found, like Jule's RNG (98% rating, 231 players), appeared only in the Top Rated row on Charts, not on Home.

Proposal: a personalized Discovery Queue

Add a short queue on Home, inspired by Steam's Discovery Queue, that matches games to each player's interests and saves a few slots for hidden gems: games with a top-25% rating, 500+ votes, and below-median players. Games that keep the players they're shown move up, and ones that don't drop out, so quality has to prove itself before it gets more exposure. It targets players who rarely try new games, and it gives good small creators their first real audience.

Experiment: how we'd test it

For two weeks, a random 10% of players would see the Discovery Queue on Home. The other 90% would see Home as it is today. Comparing the two groups shows whether the queue itself caused any change (an A/B test).

• What we're testing: whether the queue helps players find new games they come back to, without making them play less overall.

• What must not get worse: total time played, how often players return to Roblox, safety reports, and whether a few big creators take most of the new traffic.

• How many players and how long: about 82,000 players is enough to reliably detect a 1-point change (e.g., 10% → 11%). Roblox averages ~152M players a day (Q2 2026), so that's quick. We'd still run two full weeks to cover weekends and let the "it's new" excitement wear off.

Success metric

The one number that decides: the share of players each week who try a game they've never played and come back to it within 7 days. This measures finding a game you like, not just clicking one.

We'd launch it if that share goes up by more than chance would explain (statistically significant, $p < 0.05$) and no guardrail gets meaningfully worse (for example, total playtime drops no more than 1%).

Risks and limitations

- **Niche ratings:** hidden gems may be rated highly only by fans of a niche. Mitigation: match on interests, and promote only games that keep the players they're shown.
- **Gamed or unsafe content:** creators could inflate votes, or a boosted game could fail moderation. Mitigation: 500+ vote minimum, moderation check before eligibility, retention as the main promotion signal.
- **Friend spillover:** treated players may pull control-group friends into new games. Randomizing by friend cluster would fix this.

- **Data limits:** my data covers only games Roblox already featured, in 3 snapshots over 2 days during Halloween season.

Marcus Andriano · Analysis and code: github.com/MarcusAndriano/roblox-discovery